First Week Back in the Gym

A simple checklist to ease back in without overthinking it

Before you go

- [ ] Pick 3 days this week that actually fit your schedule
- [ ] Put them in your calendar like appointments
- [ ] Pack your bag the night before (shoes, water bottle, towel, headphones)
- [ ] Decide what you'll do before you walk in, even if it's just “30 minutes, whatever feels good”

At the gym

- [ ] Warm up for 5–10 minutes before anything heavy
- [ ] Start lighter than you think you need to
- [ ] Focus on learning the movement, not on the number
- [ ] Rest when you need to. There's no prize for rushing
- [ ] Ask staff how to use any machine you're unsure about

After each session

- [ ] Write down what you did (exercise, weight, sets, reps)
- [ ] Drink water
- [ ] Note one thing that went well

By the end of the week

- [ ] Showed up on the days I planned (or rescheduled instead of skipping)
- [ ] Have a simple log of what I did
- [ ] Know what I want to repeat next week

Remember

> Some soreness is common when you start again. Sharp pain isn't something to push through. Stop and get it checked.

This checklist is general information, not medical advice. Talk to a doctor or qualified professional before starting a new exercise routine, especially if you have an injury or health condition.